engaging—disseminating the right information deeply, which in itself should check the spread of misinformation.

I spoke many times at several places on the role and responsibilities of the Reserve Bank and on how all our actions and decisions are guided by the larger public good. The topic of my convocation address at Sambalpur University in February 2011 was, in fact, ‘The Reserve Bank of India: Making a Difference to Everyday Lives’. The focus of my comments at all village outreach events was to explain the activities of the Reserve Bank in a manner and at a level that semi-literate village folk could understand and relate to. I took the opportunity of my formal speeches and informal comments to explain the rationale behind some of the decisions of the Reserve Bank which were topical at that time. For example, I explained the pros and cons of deregulation of the savings deposit rate, at a town hall meeting in Bhopal as part of the extensive campaign we had launched to get public opinion on this issue in which everyone who had a bank account had an interest.

Let me illustrate with some more specific examples. I’ve already written about how we tried to simplify the language and streamline the messaging of our quarterly monetary policy statements. But even after all this reinvention, they are still too technical to be understood by people beyond the world of economics and finance. The media and the analysts do some job of interpreting and explaining our language and our message, but much of that too is beyond the reach of most people. Besides, it is no substitute for the Reserve Bank itself doing more towards disseminating its reports, explaining in non-technical language what the report says and how the expected outcomes would impact everyday lives. I used to urge the Reserve Bank’s economists to go to different parts of the country and hold seminars in collaboration with the economics departments of local universities on the Reserve Bank publications. The rule, of course, was that they should step out of the metros and go to tier-2 cities. My hope and expectation is that in the course of time, the Reserve bank itself would bring out a non-technical companion to all its technical reports.